
**PARLIAMENT OF THE DEMOCRATIC
SOCIALIST REPUBLIC OF
SRI LANKA**

UNIVERSITIES (AMENDMENT)

A

BILL

to amend the Universities Act, No. 16 of 1978

*Presented by the Prime Minister and Minister of Education, Higher Education
and Vocational Education on 03rd of December, 2025*

(Published in the Gazette on November 21, 2025)

Ordered by Parliament to be printed

[Bill No. 40]

PRINTED AT THE DEPARTMENT OF GOVERNMENT PRINTING, SRI LANKA
TO BE PURCHASED AT THE GOVERNMENT PUBLICATIONS BUREAU, COLOMBO 5

Price : Rs. 29.00

Postage : Rs. 150.00

This Bill can be downloaded from www.documents.gov.lk

STATEMENT OF LEGAL EFFECT

Clause 2: This clause amends section 49 of the Universities Act, No. 16 of 1978 (hereinafter referred to as the “principal enactment”) and the legal effect of that section as amended is to make provisions to –

- (a) enable the Faculty Board to elect a Dean from among the Senior Professors, Professors, Associate Professors and Senior Lecturers (Grade I) of the Faculty;
- (b) enable the Council to remove a Dean from his office prior to the completion of his term of office; and
- (c) introduce limitations with respect to the term of office of a Dean of a Faculty.

Clause 3: This clause amends section 51 of the principal enactment and the legal effect of that section as amended is to make provisions to –

- (a) specify the procedure to be followed by the Council when appointing a Head of a Department of Study;
- (b) enable the Council to remove the Head of a Department of Study from his office prior to the completion of his term of office; and
- (c) introduce limitations applicable with respect to the terms of office of a Head of a Department of Study.

Universities (Amendment)

L.D.-O 34/2025

AN ACT TO AMEND THE UNIVERSITIES
ACT, No. 16 OF 1978

BE it enacted by the Parliament of the Democratic Socialist
Republic of Sri Lanka as follows: -

1. This Act may be cited as the Universities (Amendment) Act, No. of 2025. Short title

5 **2.** Section 49 of the Universities Act, No.16 of 1978 Amendment
of section 49
of the Act,
No.16 of
1978
(hereinafter referred to as the “principal enactment”) is
hereby amended as follows: -

(1) in subsection (1) of that section –

10 (a) by the re-lettering of that subsection as
paragraph (a) of that subsection;

(b) by the substitution for all the words from
“The Dean shall be elected” to the end of the
re-lettered paragraph (a), of the following: -

15 “The Dean shall be elected by the
Faculty Board from among the Senior
Professors, Professors, Associate
Professors and Senior Lecturers
(Grade I), of the Faculty.”; and

20 (2) by the insertion immediately after the re-lettered
paragraph (a) of subsection (1), of the following
paragraph: -

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“(4) No person shall be appointed as the Dean of a Faculty for more than two terms.”.

Amendment of
section 51 of
the principal
enactment

(1) by the repeal of subsection (1) of that section and the substitution therefor, of the following subsection: -

“(1) (a) The Head of a Department of Study shall be a Senior Professor appointed by the Council upon the recommendation of the Vice-Chancellor.

5 (b) In the absence of a Senior Professor, a Professor, an Associate Professor, a Senior Lecturer (Grade I) or a Senior Lecturer (Grade II) shall be appointed by the Council in that order, as the Head of the Department
10 of Study, on the recommendation of the Vice-Chancellor.

 (c) Prior to make any such appointment referred to in paragraph (a) or (b), the consent of the selected individual with respect to such
15 appointment, shall be obtained.”;

(2) by the insertion immediately after subsection (1), of the following new subsection: -

 “(1A) (a) For the purpose of subsection (1), any Senior Professor, Professor, Associate
20 Professor, or any Senior Lecturer (Grade I) or any Senior Lecturer (Grade II), who has been confirmed in the relevant post, shall be eligible to be appointed as the Head of a Department of Study.

25 (b) In the absence of a Senior Professor, Professor, Associate Professor, Senior Lecturer (Grade I) or a Senior Lecturer (Grade II) for the purpose of subsection (1), who is eligible to be appointed as the Head of a Department of

Study, a Senior Professor, Professor, Associate Professor or a Senior Lecturer (Grade I) in a related discipline of another Department of Study of the same Faculty, determined by the Senate, shall be appointed in such capacity and in such an event, the Vice-Chancellor shall provide an explanation to the Council for such appointment.”;

(3) in subsection (2) of that section, by the substitution for the words “unless removed from office,”, of the words “unless removed from office by the Council,”;

(4) in subsection (3) of that section, by the substitution for the words “the Vice-Chancellor shall appoint another Professor, Associate Professor, Senior Lecturer or Lecturer”, of the words “the Council shall appoint, on the recommendation of the Vice-Chancellor, another Senior Professor, Professor, Associate Professor or a Senior Lecturer (Grade I),”; and

(5) by the addition immediately after subsection (3) of that section, of the following new subsection: -

“(4) No person shall be appointed as the Head of the same Department of Study for more than one term:

Provided that, where all eligible persons in a Department of Study have completed their terms as the Head of that Department

5 of Study in accordance with the preceding provisions, and no other eligible members are available for such appointment, a person who has previously held the post of the Head of the Department of Study may, with the consent of such person, be re-appointed to the post of the Head of the Department of Study. Such re-appointment shall be made in accordance with the procedure set out in subsection (1A):

10 Provided further, no person shall hold the post of the Head of a Department of Study for more than two consecutive terms.”.

4. In the event of any inconsistency between the Sinhala and Tamil texts of this Act, the Sinhala text shall prevail.

Sinhala text
to prevail
in case of
inconsistency

